

Becoming ants

The pupae develop into different kinds of adult ants—female soldiers and workers and male drones. Each type has its own job to do.



Soldier

Adults with the biggest jaws are called soldiers. They are daughters of the queen and develop from fertilized eggs. Soldier ants are the most aggressive and will bite to help defend the colony.



Worker

Other adults are workers. They kill small animals to provide food for the colony. They carry larvae or pupae when the colony is on the move. Like soldier ants, they develop from fertilized eggs.

Drone

The queen also produces unfertilized eggs that develop into sons called drones. Unlike the other ants, drones have wings so they can fly to other colonies and mate with other queens.

See also

Read about the breeding habits of other adult female insects, such as butterflies (80–81) and dragonflies (82–83).



Honeybee Unlike army ants, honeybees live in a fixed nest called a hive. They feed on pollen and nectar instead of meat.



Paper wasp Many wasps build nests from chewed wood and plant fibers with their saliva. The mixture then hardens in the sun.



Potter wasp Other kinds of wasps build their nests from mud, which dries to form a tough container, just like a clay pot.